

Data room handling guide

Controls for receiving, using, sharing and retiring engagement information.

AUDIENCE	Engagement team members and approved specialists
PURPOSE	Protect client information while preserving an auditable working trail.
VERSION	1.0 As of 13 Jul 2026
OWNER	Keiko Ward Information Stewardship

Access principles

Use the least access needed for the stated work. Access is time-bound, role-based and granted through the engagement administrator. Store files only in the approved engagement location; local convenience copies are not a system of record.

Before download

- Confirm the request is in scope and the source is authorized.
- Check classification and permitted recipients.
- Create a working-log entry with source, date, purpose and owner.
- Use approved file naming; never place credentials or client data in a filename.

Control record: minimum evidence for a review

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Application notes

Worked example: Client Alpha

Synthetic example data. A budget workbook referencing Client Alpha Phase 1 Finance approved diagnostic budget of JPY 42.8M is classified Engagement Confidential. It may be used for the Phase 1 workstream, but must not be copied to a general training folder.

Sharing and disposal

Share links rather than uncontrolled attachments. Recheck access after team changes. On closeout, follow the engagement retention schedule, remove working copies where authorized, and record any client-returned material.

Decision worksheet

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Practice note. Use concise records that make the next decision easier. This guide is an internal operating reference; it is not a substitute for engagement-specific governance.

Execution and review

Incident response

If a file is misdirected, access appears excessive, or content may be exposed: stop distribution, preserve facts, notify the engagement lead and information steward immediately, and do not attempt informal cleanup that obscures the event.

Practical checklist

- Confirm the purpose and audience before working from the guide.
- Maintain clear distinction between verified facts, assumptions and synthetic examples.
- Record accountable owner, next step and decision date.
- Invite an independent reviewer when conclusions or access risks are material.
- Update the engagement record after the decision is made.

Sign-off prompts

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

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